later at the Indian border post at Khenzemane where he was received by 5 Assam Rifles.

Four days later, furious that the Dalai Lama had escaped, the Chinese gunned down hundreds of men, women and children, especially those who were camped around the palace. Two hundred members of the Dalai Lama's bodyguard who had stayed behind in Lhasa were disarmed and publicly machine-gunned. Lhasa's major monasteries, Gaden, Sera and Drepung were shelled—the latter two beyond repair—and monastic treasures and precious scriptures destroyed. Many monks were either killed on the spot, or transported to the city to work as slave labour. In house-to-house searches, any resident found to have any weapon was dragged out and shot on the spot.

On 3 April, Nehru announced that the Indian government was granting asylum to the Dalai Lama. Needless to say, the Chinese were livid.

By then, India's official head-in-the-sand attitude towards China's repeated provocations was starting to change. Incursions in both the Ladakh Sector of Kashmir and in the Lohit Valley clearly indicated that having completed G219 through the Aksai Chin, the Chinese were looking at further expansion. On 23 June, the Indian consul was given a note by the foreign officer in Peking that said: 'According to well-founded report received by the Chinese Government, the Migyitun area in the south eastern part of the Tibetan region of China was intruded, shelled (and) occupied by over 200 Indian troops. These Indian troops, equipped with radio stations and weapons of various types, were building military work around Migyitun.' This was strongly denied by the Indians, but now the obscure village of Longju (near Migyitun), was on the map.

In August 1959, two incidents quickly followed each other—clear indications that the Chinese were now determined to up the ante.

The Ministry of External Affairs recorded that on 7 August approximately 200 armed Chinese soldiers appeared at Khenzemane. An Assam Rifles patrol challenged them and requested them to withdraw to their own territory. Instead of complying, they pushed the dozen or so Indians back almost a kilometre to the Drokung Samba Bridge. After a while the Chinese withdrew and the Assam Rifles followed them back to Khenzemane. The Indians then established a picket there and raised the tricolour. The Chinese once again came back, but the Assam Rifles held